

IDENTITY AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

Mid-Semester Exam

Date: 22nd September 2026

Time: 1.5 hours

Total Marks: 30

Instructions:

There are 6 questions and all questions are compulsory. Please keep your answers brief and precise.

Please note: Use of calculators are allowed but no other electronic devices can be used even if they have a calculating feature such as phones, ipads, etc.

Answer the following questions:

1. Briefly explain two key findings of Vithayathil and Singh's 2012 paper on residential segregation in Indian cities.

(2 marks)

2. Explain what problems arise when the Duncan Dissimilarity Index is used to measure Residential Segregation.

(3 marks)

3. How does Stratification Economics differ from Orthodox Economics in explaining intergroup inequality? Discuss two key differences, using the arguments developed in the reading.

(4 marks)

4. Barbara Fields argues that the historical development of racial ideology in the United States cannot be understood simply as the discovery of a pre-existing racial reality.

a. According to Fields, what changed in the relationship between slavery and race after the American Revolution?

b. Why did the new political language of freedom and equality create a problem for the continued existence of slavery?

c. What role did racial ideology play in resolving this contradiction?

(2+2+2=6 marks)

5. a. What does Amartya Sen mean by Social Exclusion?

b. Explain the following distinctions, giving one illustrative example for each:

- Constitutive vs. instrumental exclusion
- Exclusion vs. unfavourable inclusion
- Active vs. passive exclusion

(1+2+2+2=7 marks)

6. Consider the following table with data for a hypothetical city with 6 wards having Scheduled Caste (SC) and non-Scheduled Caste (non-SC) population.

Ward	Area (sq. km.)	SC 2015	Non-SC 2015	SC 2025	Non-SC 2025
W1	1	298	1,756	201	2,187
W2	2	100	892	543	819
W3	1	234	663	279	1,996
W4	3	380	947	471	593
W5	1	497	1,120	245	1,448
W6	2	450	1,721	162	967
Total	10	1,959	7,099	1,901	8,010

Using data from the above table, calculate the isolation indices and the concentration indices (delta) for 2015 and 2025 and compare. In one or two sentences explain what conclusion you can draw from this comparison.
(8 marks)